

CUSK EELS

Most members of the order Ophidiiformes live in the ocean and are long, slim, eel-like fish. They have thin pelvic fins and long dorsal and anal fins, which in many species join onto the tail fin.



PEARLFISH
Carapus acus
F: Carapidae

The adult pearlfish finds refuge inside a sea cucumber, entering tail-first through the anus, exiting at night to feed.

21 cm
8½ in

GREY MULLET

Grey mullets are silvery striped fish with two widely separated dorsal fins; the first has sharp spines, the second has soft rays. Members of the Mugiliformes are distributed worldwide. They are vegetarian, feeding on fine algae and detritus.



GOLDEN GREY MULLET
Liza aurata
F: Mugilidae

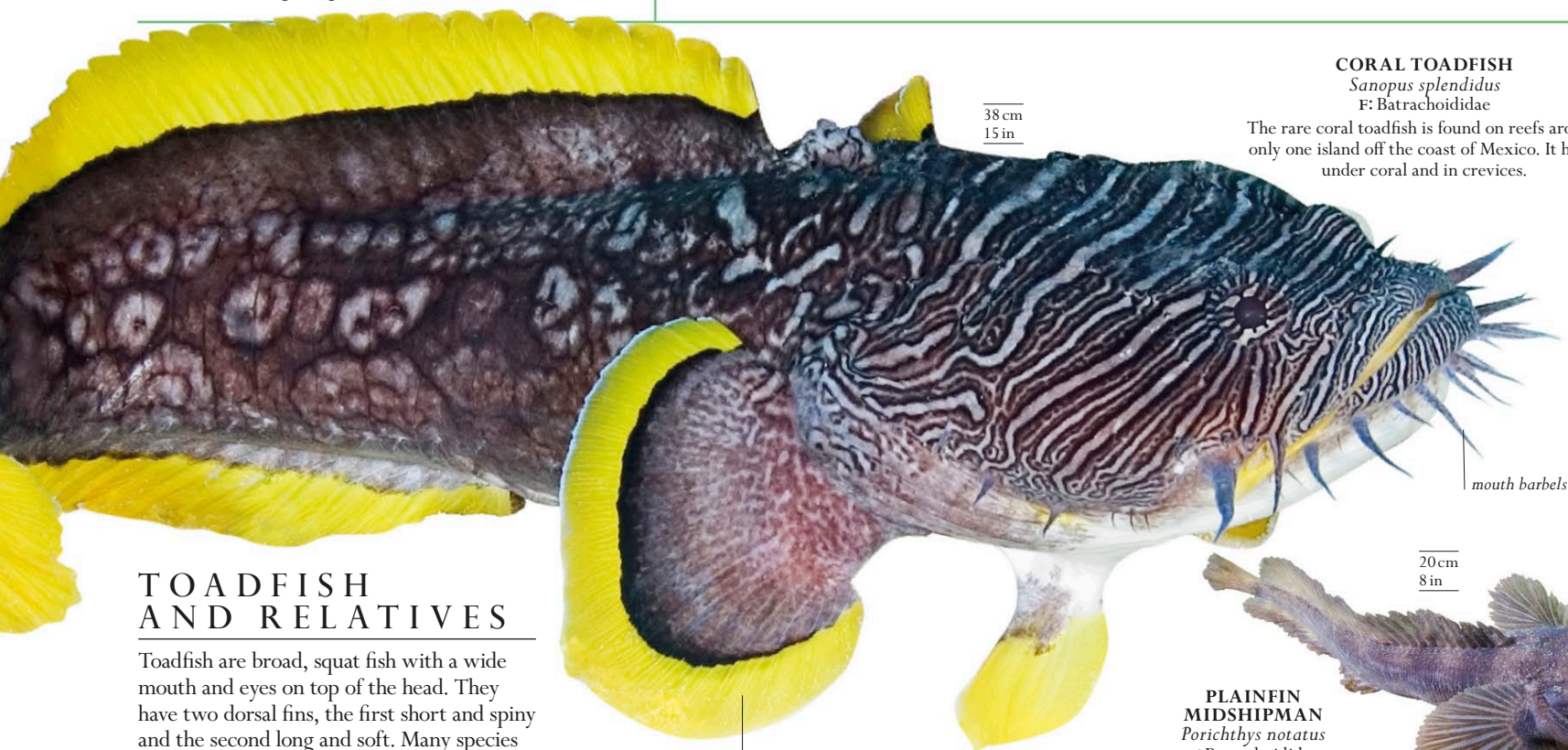
Harbours, estuaries, and coastal waters in the N.E. Atlantic are all likely haunts of the this mullet, which often lives in shoals.

75 cm
30 in

CORAL TOADFISH

Sanopus splendidus
F: Batrachoididae

The rare coral toadfish is found on reefs around only one island off the coast of Mexico. It hides under coral and in crevices.



38 cm
15 in

mouth barbels

TOADFISH AND RELATIVES

Toadfish are broad, squat fish with a wide mouth and eyes on top of the head. They have two dorsal fins, the first short and spiny and the second long and soft. Many species of the Batrachoidiformes, especially the midshipmen, are known for the remarkable way they use their swim bladder to produce sound.

large pectoral fins
used for "walking"

**PLAINFIN
MIDSHIPMAN**
Porichthys notatus
F: Batrachoididae

Living on the rocky shores along the west coast of N. America, this fish can breathe air to survive when the tide goes out.

20 cm
8 in

SILVERSIDES AND RELATIVES

These small, slim silvery fish often live in large shoals. There are over 330 Atheriniformes, occurring both in marine and freshwater habitats. Most have two dorsal fins, the first of which has flexible spines, and a single anal fin.

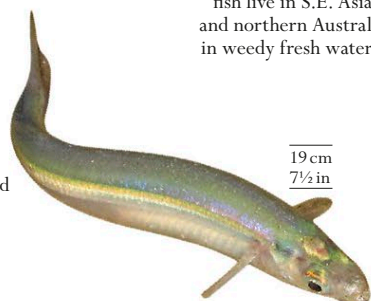


CALIFORNIA GRUNION
Leuresthes tenuis
F: Atherinopsidae

Grunion spawn together in thousands depositing eggs in sand on the shore at night during high spring tides.

4 cm
1½ in

**THREADFIN
RAINBOWFISH**
Iriatherina wernerii
F: Melanotaeniidae
Mature males of this species display to females with their long fins. These fish live in S.E. Asia and northern Australia in weedy fresh waters.



19 cm
7½ in

NEEDLEFISH AND RELATIVES

With a long, thin, rod-like body and extended beak-like jaws, these silvery fish are well camouflaged in the open ocean. Flying fish – with their large, paired pectoral (side) and pelvic (belly) fins – also belong to this order, the Beloniformes.



GARFISH
Belone belone
F: Belonidae

Remaining close to the ocean surface in the N.E. Atlantic, this needlefish chases small fish, especially members of the herring family.

93 cm
3 ft

**ATLANTIC
FLYINGFISH**
Cheilopogon heterurus
F: Exocoetidae

Pursued by predators or startled by boats, this fish escapes by powering up into the air and gliding away on outspread fins.



40 cm
16 in